

AXIOM

Corporate Graphic Identity Guidelines

Decision systems for cities, governments, and operators.
Production systems, not decks. Form explains function. The
grid does the work.



Axiom is an operating surface.

The brand is not a decorative skin. It is a decision protocol made visible. It must work under stress, in rooms with multiple humans, and on screens where 30 seconds is all the user has.

OPERATING CONVICTIONS

- Form explains function instantly.
- The human comes first.
- Simplicity orders complexity; it does not erase it.
- Color carries meaning or it does not appear.
- Alignment and hairlines do the work.
- A resolved system feels inevitable.

MANUAL SET

01 Brand manual

Full system: logo, color, type, grid, components, motion, voice.

02 Quick reference

One-file rulebook for partners and fast production.

03 Implementation checklist

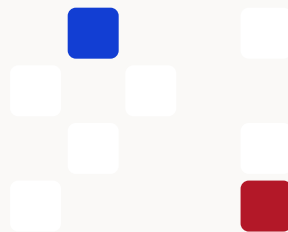
Shipping test for websites, dashboards, decks, and documents.

LOGO SYSTEM

The Axiom mark is a field of decisions. The rounded navy square is the operating room. The tiles are states, routes, and consequences. The blue tile signals the point of command. The red tile marks risk. White tiles are the disciplined field of action.



Primary app icon



Corporate tile mark

- Primary app icon: full rounded-square field with raised tile mark. Use for product icons, app stores, favicon families, launch screens, and social avatars.
- Corporate mark: vector tile symbol without the field. Use sparingly in documents, title pages, stamps, and monochrome contexts.
- Wordmark lockup: AXIOM in Helvetica Neue / Inter, uppercase, tracking -0.01em to 0.04em depending on size. Never use a futuristic display font.
- Clear space: keep at least one tile width around the mark. For the app icon, use one-sixth of the icon side as the minimum safe zone.
- Minimum size: app icon 24px. Corporate tile mark 18px. Below that, use the word AXIOM only.

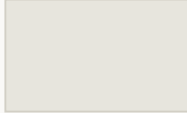
LOGO CONSTRUCTION

The mark follows a square-cell logic. Do not redraw it by eye. The cell grid gives the brand its engineered character. The spacing must feel measured, not playful.

- Tiles sit on an implied modular grid. Corners are softened only because the physical tile motif requires it.
- The outer field may keep its larger radius in app-icon usage. Interface components may not inherit that radius.
- Do not rotate, stretch, outline, bevel, extrude, add shadows, or animate the logo.
- Do not place the mark over photography or textured backgrounds unless it sits on its navy field.
- For government decks, use the full icon on cover pages and the wordmark in running headers.

COLOR ARCHITECTURE

Axiom has two color systems. The corporate mark has identity colors. The operating interface has signal colors. Do not mix the grammars.

				
Navy field #161d31 identity field	Axiom blue #123ed3 logo command tile	Axiom red #b31828 logo risk tile	Signal green #1f6e43 UI live/action	Hairline #e7e5dd grid line

- Corporate identity: Navy, white, Axiom blue, and Axiom red. These are reserved for the logo and high-level identity moments.
- Interface foundation: warm paper, panel white, warm ink, hairline grey.
- Signal accent: one accent only. In the current system, use desaturated forest green for live/positive/primary action.
- Negative data: muted brick red only. It is not a second accent and never styles a button or heading.
- Color appears at the point of decision. Enclosed color means identity. Bare color means data state.

TYPOGRAPHY

The voice is neo-grotesque. Neutral. Precise. Modern without costume. Typography is structure, not styling.

AXIOM

Helvetica Neue / Inter · tabular figures · weight ceiling 600

- Primary family: Helvetica Neue, Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif. Inter is acceptable where Helvetica Neue is unavailable.
- Use tabular figures for dashboards, financial data, time, coordinates, and KPIs.
- Data weight ceiling: 600. Heavy data looks panicked.
- Labels are small, uppercase, letterspaced, and grey. Values are larger and darker.
- No serif, rounded, futuristic, stencil, techno, handwritten, or decorative typefaces.

GRID, SPACE, LAYOUT

Axiom layouts should feel like instrument panels. Not cards. Not posters. Not friendly software bubbles. Order comes from baseline alignment and hairlines.

- Use a base unit near 11px. Outer padding 22px. Cell padding 12-16px. Section gaps 22-24px.
- Build dense data with 1px hairline cell grids: line-color background, 1px gap, white cells.
- Left-align labels and text. Right-align numbers. Use baseline alignment in rows.
- Whitespace is structural. It groups, separates, and lowers stress.
- Avoid centered dense content. Avoid arbitrary offsets. Avoid ornamental containers.

COMPONENT SYSTEM

Components are vocabulary. Use fewer of them. Make each one predictable. A user should learn the system once.

LIVE SYSTEMS 21 production surfaces	FEEDS 47 verified sources	TIME TO READ 30s operator target
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- Section header: uppercase label, wide tracking, black rule, optional grey meta on the right.
- Stat cell: 9px label, 20px value, 10px sublabel. No icon unless it beats text.
- Data row: label, value, delta. One hairline separator. Baseline-aligned.
- Bar/meter: square-ended flat track and fill. No gradient, glow, radius, or shadow.
- Status plate: black tag plus body. Use for state changes, modes, alerts, and board headers.

WAYFINDING

Axiom borrows the discipline of transit systems. Information appears at the point of decision. Never before. Never after.



- Use route discs for board identity: perfect circle, trunk color, white glyph, no border, no shadow.
- Station plates identify major boards: disc, code, board name, one trunk-color rule.
- Directional arrow: solid triangle only. No unicode arrows, chevrons, or decorative icons.
- Limit visible trunk families. Five is the practical maximum in one view.
- Do not repeat a board color throughout its body. The board body returns to monochrome.

MOTION AND INTERACTION

Motion confirms. It does not entertain. The operator needs feedback, not theatre.

- Every action produces visible feedback within 100ms.
- State changes complete within 150ms.
- The only sanctioned loop is the slow live-status pulse.
- No entrance animation, scroll reveal, parallax, bounce, glow, or decorative loop.
- Prevent errors through constraints. Disable impossible actions before users can fail.

VOICE AND WRITING

Axiom writes like a system that already works. Calm authority. No hype. No poetry pretending to be strategy.

- Short sentences. One idea per sentence.
- Active voice: We built. The system routes. The dashboard reads.
- Numbers over adjectives. Replace “fast” with “45-minute prototype” or delete it.
- No exclamation marks. No emojis. No corporate filler.
- Respectful density: assume the reader is smart and busy.

APPLICATIONS

The same rules must hold across product, website, dashboards, decks, printed documents, signage, and procurement material.

- Website: warm paper background, sticky cockpit header, dense proof grids, one primary action.
- Dashboard: critical instruments visible, provenance line under data, no decorative visualization.
- Deck: cover can use the full app icon. Inner slides use hairline grids and large proof numbers.
- Document: 720px reading width equivalent, clear section hierarchy, no ornamental cover graphics.
- Partner material: preserve the identity system. Do not "localize" with extra colors or stock photos.

DO / DON'T

The brand fails when it becomes decoration. The bans protect the system from drift.

- Do use warm neutrals, hairlines, restrained type, clear data provenance, and one signal color.
- Do keep the logo stable and give it clear space.
- Do write with evidence and operational clarity.
- Don't use gradients, drop shadows, glows, glassmorphism, stock imagery, emoji, or decorative icons.
- Don't use pure black, pure white, bold-everything, centered data, tooltips as a substitute for clarity, or arbitrary colors.

GOVERNANCE

Identity is a system. Treat deviations as technical debt. Allow evolution only through tokens, not taste.

- Allowed knobs: accent hue, neutral temperature, density, container width, family map, glyphs, disc scale, and rule weight.
- Untouchable: one-accent rule, no-decoration rule, weight ceiling, label tracking, color grammar, baseline discipline, and human-first design questions.
- Every new asset must pass the checklist: legibility, hierarchy, color grammar, data honesty, interaction feedback, and brand restraint.
- For external agencies, send this manual, the quick reference, and the checklist. Do not send only the logo file.
- When in doubt, remove. If removal loses meaning, shrink. If it still matters, hide behind a decision point. If it must stay visible, embody its function.

The release test

- ☐ Who is the human, what is their context, and what decision must they make?
- ☐ Does every visible element serve that decision?
- ☐ Can a new user understand the primary action in 10 seconds?
- ☐ Does every action produce visible feedback within 100ms?
- ☐ Are numbers right-aligned and labels left-aligned?
- ☐ Is color either enclosed identity or bare data signal?
- ☐ Is every data point honest about provenance, date, delay, or uncertainty?
- ☐ Can the design lose one more thing without losing meaning?
- ☐ Do the page and components survive mobile, desktop, and presentation-room display?
- ☐ Would a rational operator trust this at 2 AM?